worried, as they could not fail to notice the growing bitterness in Pakistan towards Britain and the Commonwealth.[10] The dominant British presence in India and Pakistan through 1947–49 affected the war and diplomacy in Kashmir. London knew that supporting India could destroy Pakistan and with it, the agenda of the British deep state. It also believed that a Muslim Pakistan would stand against Soviet Russia more than a non-aligned India; but, the British also admitted that it could not afford to totally alienate India given the country's many economic investments and military ties. Each of these concerns came together when deciding on the issuance of stand-down orders to British officers serving in Indian and Pakistani armies and what should've been the 'party line' at the UN. This approach aroused the Soviets, who were historically clued into Kashmir from much before than is credited for. The Kashmir dispute had embarked upon a spell of internationalisation that would remain intact throughout the 20th century.

The Americans Get Interested

In December 1950, the CIA prepared a note on communist personalities and activities in Kashmir that named B. P. L. Bedi, his wife Freda, G. M. Sadiq, Mirza Afzal Beg, Mohiuddin Kara and Dhanwantri.[11] It highlighted the editorial line taken by publications like *Noor*, *Uplift* and *Burj*, which were allegedly funded by the Soviet and Czech embassies in New Delhi. It was especially concerned about the Bedi's, whom it had earlier called the 'leading light' of communism in Sheikh Abdullah's administration. The Bedi's were instrumental in keeping the 'inner core' of Abdullah, Bakshi and Sadiq intact. Deeply involved in the 'nationalisation' of land as well as textbooks, Bedi, however, disturbed the New Delhi Government as much as he was bothering Washington and London.

In January 1951, Col. Coblentz of the US Army and the acting chief of UN's Kashmir Observers returned to Washington after serving there for two years and told the state department that the Abdullah regime, which according to Coblentz had 'no following' and survived on 'intimidation',